

# Hatching & Texture Marks

## Building tone with line

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Hatching is the technique of using parallel lines to suggest tone and shadow. It's one of the oldest mark-making traditions in drawing and a foundational skill for pencil, pen, and ink work.

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### KEY CONCEPTS

#### Types of Hatching

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Hatching: parallel lines in one direction. Cross-hatching: two or more layers of hatching at different angles. Contour hatching: lines that follow the form of the object. Scribble/random hatching: loose marks for texture.

#### Building Value

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The closer the lines are spaced, the darker the tone appears. Start with widely spaced lines and add layers. Never try to get dark values in one pass — build up gradually. Consistent line weight makes cleaner-looking hatching.

#### Directional Hatching

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The direction of your hatching lines communicates form. Lines that follow the surface of a sphere will read differently than flat vertical lines — the former suggests roundness, the latter suggests flatness. Use direction intentionally.

#### Pen vs Pencil

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Ink hatching must commit to each line — no erasing. Pencil allows correction but requires more care not to smudge. Pen hatching is typically crisper and higher contrast; pencil hatching is softer and more blendable.

### PRACTICE EXERCISES

1. Create a 5-step value scale using only parallel hatching (white → black).
  2. Draw a sphere using contour hatching — lines that wrap around the form.
  3. Fill a page with cross-hatching experiments: vary spacing, angle, and layers.
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### FURTHER READING

#### ■ Proko – Hatching Techniques

<https://youtu.be/OcJPNMFFKHs>

#### ■ New Masters – Mark Making

[https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b\\_w\\_hdwafV8](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=b_w_hdwafV8)